

UNIVERSITY OF CENTRAL MISSOURI HACKATHON RULES & GUIDELINES

Official Participant Handbook

By registering and competing, you agree to follow this handbook in full.

1. ELIGIBILITY & REGISTRATION

- Current college and high school students are eligible to participate in Mule Hacks 2026.
- Participants must complete registration before the official event start time.
- Participants under the age of 18 must have a signed permission slip from a parent or legal guardian and must be accompanied **throughout the event by the adult listed on the permission slip**.
- At check-in, participants will use the QR code provided through the Mule Hacks website.
- The participant QR code will also serve as their event identification throughout the hackathon.
- Each participant may compete on only one team.

2. TEAM FORMATION

- Team size: 1–4 participants.
- Teams may form before the event or during the designated team-formation window.
- Team names and final rosters must be submitted by the submission deadline. Roster changes after the deadline require organizer approval.
- Solo participants are welcome and judged under the same criteria as multi-person teams.

3. PROJECT & BUILD RULES

All project work submitted for judging must be created during the official hacking period.

- Public APIs, open-source libraries, SDKs, datasets, and frameworks are allowed.
- Pre-existing personal or team codebases, prior course projects, and unfinished side projects may not be submitted as part of the solution.
- AI coding assistants and generative tools are allowed unless a track rule states otherwise; teams must be able to explain every major design decision.
- Hardware may be used as part of a team's submission; however, hardware will not be provided by the event and must be supplied and brought to the venue by the team.

Originality Standard

If judges or organizers reasonably believe substantial work was completed before the event, the team may be disqualified or have scores adjusted.

4. CODE OF CONDUCT

- Treat mentors, volunteers, sponsors, judges, and fellow hackers with respect.
- No hate speech, sexual harassment, or personal attacks — online or in person.
- Do not sabotage, plagiarize, or misrepresent another team's work.
- Follow venue, lab, and equipment safety rules at all times.
- Report concerns promptly to organizers; confidentiality will be respected to the extent possible.

Violations may result in warnings, removal from the venue, disqualification, or referral to university conduct processes.

5. RESOURCES, MENTORS & SPONSORS

- Mentors may advise, teach, and debug with teams, but should not write the core solution for a team.
- Sponsor tools, APIs, and prize tracks may have additional requirements — read track rules carefully.
- Competitors will use the **UCM Guest Network** for internet access. Connection instructions will be available on the Mule Hacks website before the event.
- Power and internet access will be provided as available; teams should plan for contingencies.

6. SUBMISSION & JUDGING

To be eligible for judging, each team must submit their project through **Devpost** by the submission deadline.

The Devpost submission must include:

- Project title, team name, and project description
- Link to the source repository
- List of technologies used
- A short demo video showing the project and its core functionality

After submissions close, entire teams will participate in an in-person **technical demonstration** where they will present the working project to judges, explain how it was built, and answer technical questions.

7. LOGISTICS & SAFETY

- Designated sleeping areas for participants are **Rooms 126, 218, 220, and the Math Lab**. Participants must respect others using these spaces and keep noise to a minimum.
- **No food or drinks are permitted in the NAHM Auditorium.**
- Alcohol, illegal substances, and weapons are prohibited.
- After **7:00 PM**, the doors to WCM will lock. Participants returning to the building after this time must use their **Mule Hacks QR code through the website** to regain entry.
- For campus security assistance, contact **(660) 543-4123**.

University of Central Missouri

Organizers reserve the right to amend these rules for fairness, safety, or logistics. Updates will be announced officially.